

Human Intention Towards Restoration

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INTRODUCTION

Ritik Sarraf- What is restoration? How it is beneficial to the recover the lost naturalness of the nature? How human activities has shaped the concept of restoration and providing real life examples?

Parker Hayden-

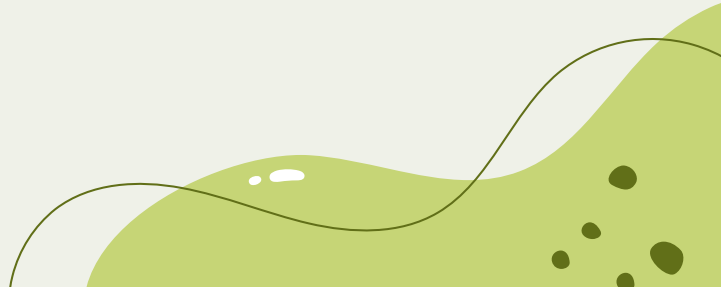
How can restoration be harmful, real life examples of the issues with restoration, how can we make restoration more effective

Concept of Restoration

- Restoration is an attempt to repair or recreate damaged natural environments.
- This often involves the direct human intervention or the use of advanced technological equipments.
- Although, restoration process is what we call it “imperfect” and might bring disturbances temporarily to the ecosystem, eventually in the long run it is meant for the good sake of the nature, its species and beauty.
- Although, human activities are involved in its destruction but at the same time we are the one held with moral responsibilities to fix it.
- Humans effort towards restoration have been significant in decades as technological advancements has evolved.



- **Examples:**

- i. Repairing the environment after logging, pollution, or other forms of destructions
 - It lays foundation to progressive healing of the nature. It can also be seen as opportunity to embrace nature-human relation through time spent in the forest and carrying out restoration process.
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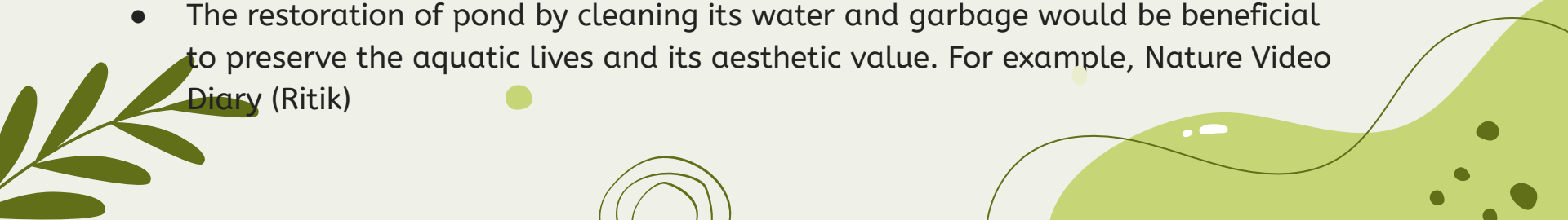
Relating Ideas from the Text

- Forest Ethics article recognizes the value and importance of restoration and is being taken as a necessary step towards sustainability and future ecological functioning.
- The Faking Nature article share about the idea of restoration that is philosophically challenged in terms of human intervention that disrupts the “naturalness” pattern and makes the nature artificial or unreal which was previously considered “untouched by humans”.
- Elliott portrays that the concept of restoration is not ideal as it cannot retain the naturalness of nature once its lost with human intervention or the use of technology.
- I will be further be discussing about the restoration and why its necessity is a core to protect nature in the long run, the world we live in today?

Influence of Restoration Towards the Nature

- Fisheries Farm, Pond, Forest, wildlife habitat, Ocean are integral part of the nature. Thus, it is necessary to keep it protected and conserved.
- It is proven beneficial to protect the keystone species and endangered species from wildfire, habitat destruction and hunting.
- Restoration provides such species with rehabilitation to keep protected from external factors.
- Building Beaver dam helps provide the habitat for Eurasian beaver.



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- Beaver Dam slow down waterways, creating extensive wetlands upstream that house vast amounts of biodiversity.
 - Thus, vegetation also flourishes, increasing the number of herbaceous plants in the area by over 33%
 - The Copper River Watershed Project (2022) in Alaska was awarded \$1,000,901 over three years to replace two narrow 11-foot pipes with a clear span bridge.
 - This project will provide passage for Chinook and coho salmon to 45 miles of habitat.
 - It has become a commercial hub for salmon fisheries that drives the economies of the rural communities in the Copper River watershed, generating \$23-40 million annually.
 - The restoration of pond by cleaning its water and garbage would be beneficial to preserve the aquatic lives and its aesthetic value. For example, Nature Video Diary (Ritik)
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Humans Influence Towards the Concept of Restoration

- The fulfillment of human needs are complex to analyze in a sense how it could be satisfied.
- In fact, the human does have to involve directly or indirectly with the environment that adds to destruction, even minor ones to fulfill the needs.
- I believe this is not necessarily to be seen from the negative perspective.
- The extraction of raw materials from the nature to fulfill needs do require human intervention.
- There are no alternatives to fulfillment of needs without being extracted from currently available resources in the ecosystem.



- The concept implies that “To gain something you must lose something.” Here it comes about the opportunity cost.
- Human as a moral being we think cautiously about individual and need of family members.
- I believe the extraction of resources from the nature creates a gap between “then” and “now” nature means “pre” and “post” extraction.
- Restoration acts to bridge the gap between pre and post nature.
- The best way to have the ecosystem and biodiversity flourished is through restoration that we promise to live upto today.



- As it lays foundation to progressive healing of the nature and gives certainty about it being restored with proper care and foster.
- Hence, restoration shall not be seen as negative aspect rather it provides opportunity to retain trust to keep up the nature-human relationship inseparable.
- For example: In the case of running factories to create furniture or clothing industry. They both work differently but eventually rely on the extraction of raw materials from the nature itself. Wooden furniture manufacturing requires tree logs to create furniture whereas clothing industry needs wool or cotton to manufacture clothes.



- The extraction of the raw materials is not possible without even minimal disruptions to the nature.
- For example, trees has to be chopped down even in a frequency of just one per day at minimal and there are no alternatives to create wooden furniture.
- Research shows that human efforts were significant in removal of 99 Million pounds of plastic out of the oceans around the world through multiple attempts amidst 2010-2020.





Counter Arguments

Parker Hayden



Restoration can be an excuse for destruction and profit

- Restoration appears as fixed and all better –can't rebuild an ecosystem
- A “fixed” environment appears as one we take recourse from
- We destroy forests, fix them and destroy them again
- Humans have been taking restoration for granted.
- Humans don't often look for long term goals and eventually these short term cycles will lead to permanent environmental harm.

Human interference can be disguised as Restoration

Ritik's pond example:

- When the pond is cleaned it appears to be restored, however it is destroyed and restored every week by a maintenance person which is so often that the pond is now merely pretending to appear as an ecosystem. The common Restoration leads to its destruction



Restoration is not as helpful as it appears

- When humans destroy a forest and then “restore it” they see it as if they reversed the damage that they have done.
- We cannot reverse the damage, there is millions of ecosystems and billions of complicated organisms within them. we cannot replenish them all by replanting what we cut down.
- It takes lifetimes to restore the complicated ecosystem and even longer for the countless species living there to repopulate

Battle against plastic

The sad statistics- it took multiple years to make a world record trash cleanup of our oceans, the clean up took over 99,000,000 pounds of plastic out of our oceans around the world.

Did this amazing task of science and engineering and human kindness make a difference? Nope not at all.

Research shows that there is around 33 billion pounds of plastics going into marine environments EVERY YEAR.

Scientists estimate that by 2050 there will be more pounds of plastic in the ocean than pounds of OCEAN LIFE!!

[Record ocean cleanup removes 45 million kilograms of plastic - Earth.com](#)

[Plastic Pollution Statistics: Key Facts and Data \(2026\) • Environmental Nonprofit Organization](#)

Restoration needs to be the final say

Example:

We attempt to restore our oceans through cleaning up plastics but more plastic goes in than we can pull out

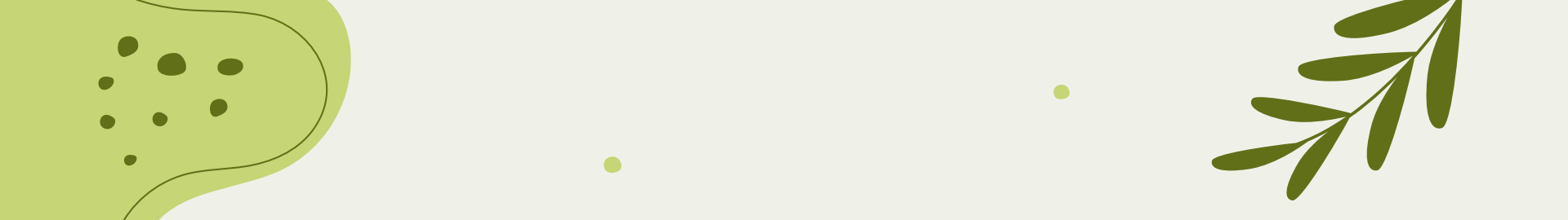
The issue with this restoration:

People see that we took “99,000,000” pounds of plastic out of the ocean and think we have the issue solved when it did nothing at all.

Solution:

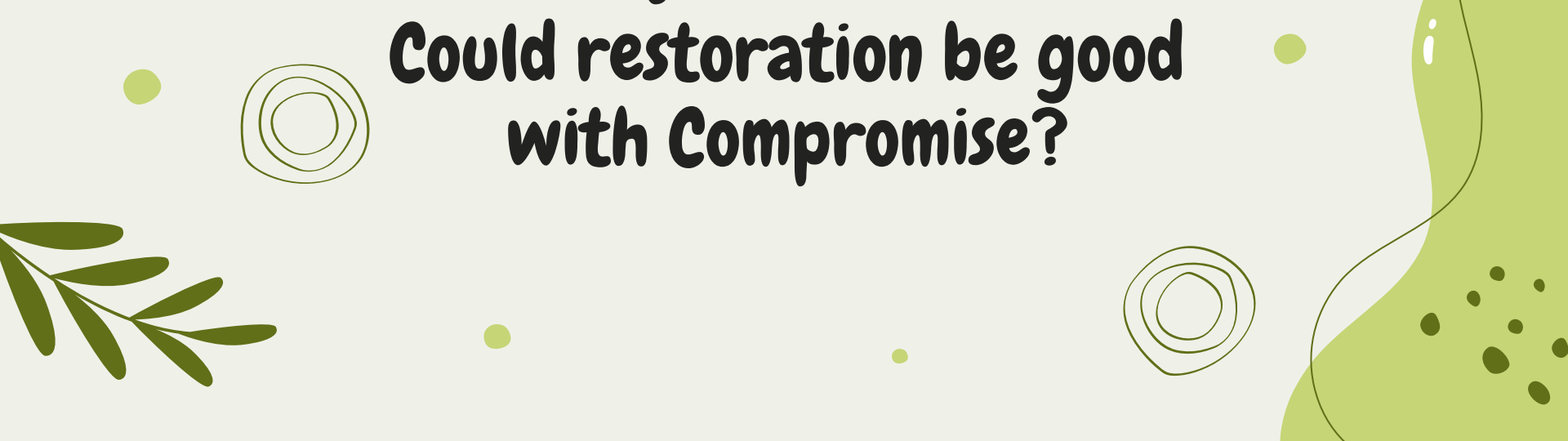
Plastic production especially one use plastics need to be banned forever to even make Ocean restoration helpful





Compromise

Could restoration be good
with Compromise?





**Restoration
can be good!**

- Our intention towards restoration needs to be pure.
 - It cannot be to prepare more recourses for our gain.
- We need to come at restoration with an appropriate plan that fits the long term goals:
 - Banning what is damaging the environment and then removing it forever
- We need to restore and protect
 - Once an environment is fixed as much as possible it needs to be left alone to truly heal

How Restoration has Evolved?

- Through trial and error and finally paying more attention to the environments, we can now see that our restoration of environments is no where near perfect.
- We see now that We can't just "fix" a forest, it needs a very long time in order to get itself restored like originally.
- Through this discovery we have made protection apart of the restoration process in some cases but sadly not all.
- When a forest is "restored" by us we now know to protect it and let it not be touched in order for it to fully heal from the damage made.





Thank you!

Sources

- [Record ocean cleanup removes 45 million kilograms of plastic - Earth.com](#)
 - [Plastic Pollution Statistics: Key Facts and Data \(2026\) • Environmental Nonprofit Organization](#)
 - <https://www.fisheries.noaa.gov/national/habitat-conservation/current-and-past-community-based-restoration-projects>
 - <https://www.oneearth.org/species-of-the-week-eurasian-beavers/>
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